

Workshop setup

Do this before the workshop, at home. Ten minutes, plus a download you should not leave until the last evening.

Two things are involved: **the software** (about 5 GB — Docker fetches it) and **your folder** (about 10 MB — you download and unzip it). Docker does not know your folder exists until you start it from inside that folder.

Windows

1. Install Docker Desktop

docker.com/products/docker-desktop → install → restart when asked → launch it. Wait until the whale icon in the system tray stops animating.

2. Download your workshop folder

Download **flow-workshop-setup.zip** from the link in the workshop email. Right-click it → **Extract All** → extract to C:\Users\<you>\

You should end up with a folder at C:\Users\<you>\flow-workshop\. **Not** Documents, Desktop or OneDrive — those sync to the cloud, which breaks things.

3. Open a terminal there

Open the flow-workshop folder in File Explorer → click the address bar → type powershell → Enter.

4. Get the software (~5 GB) — pick one

You have	Run this
Good internet	Nothing. Step 5 will download it for you.
The USB stick	<code>docker load -i D:\flow-workshop-r-2026.09-amd64.tar.gz</code>
Downloaded the file	<code>docker load -i \$HOME\Downloads\flow-workshop-r-2026.09-amd64.tar.gz</code>

Snapdragon / ARM laptop? Use the arm64 file instead. Check: Settings → System → About → System type.

5. Start the container

```
docker compose up -d
```

The first time takes a while — 5 GB to download or unpack. When the prompt comes back it is running; later starts take seconds.

6. Check it works

Open **http://localhost:8787** — no password needed.

In the **Files** pane (bottom right): workshop → 00-check-your-setup.Rmd.

Run it: click **Knit** above the file (Ctrl+Shift+K), or **Run ► Run All** (Ctrl+Alt+R). Look for a line starting SETUP OK and **reply to the workshop email with it**. If it says anything else, send the whole output.

7. Stop it

`docker compose down` — your files stay. `docker compose up -d` starts it again anytime.

macOS

1. Install Docker Desktop

docker.com/products/docker-desktop → install → launch it from Applications. Wait until the whale icon in the menu bar stops animating.

Then: **Docker Desktop** → **Settings** → **Resources** → **Memory** → **8 GB** → **Apply & Restart**. The default is too small for this workshop.

2. Download your workshop folder

Download **flow-workshop-setup.zip** from the link in the workshop email. Safari usually unzips it for you; otherwise double-click it.

Drag the resulting **flow-workshop** folder into your home folder, so you end up with `/Users/<you>/flow-workshop/`. (In Finder, that is the one with the house icon — *Shift+Cmd+H* if you cannot see it.)

3. Open a terminal there

Open **Terminal** (Cmd+Space, type `terminal`, Enter). Type `cd` — with a space after it — then drag the `flow-workshop` folder from Finder onto the Terminal window and press Enter.

4. Get the software (~5 GB) — pick one

You have	Run this
Good internet	Nothing. Step 5 will download it for you.
The USB stick	<code>docker load -i /Volumes/<stick>/flow-workshop-r-2026.09-arm64.tar.gz</code>
Downloaded the file	<code>docker load -i ~/Downloads/flow-workshop-r-2026.09-arm64.tar.gz</code>

Apple Silicon (M1/M2/M3/M4) uses the arm64 file; an older Intel Mac uses amd64. Check: Apple menu → About This Mac — “Chip: Apple ...” means Apple Silicon.

5. Start the container

```
docker compose up -d
```

The first time takes a while — 5 GB to download or unpack. When the prompt comes back it is running; later starts take seconds.

6. Check it works

Open **http://localhost:8787** — no password needed.

In the **Files** pane (bottom right): `workshop` → `00-check-your-setup.Rmd`.

Run it: click **Knit** above the file (Cmd+Shift+K), or **Run ▶ Run All** (Cmd+Option+R). Look for a line starting `SETUP OK` and **reply to the workshop email with it**. If it says anything else, send the whole output.

7. Stop it

```
docker compose down
```

 — your files stay.

```
docker compose up -d
```

 starts it again anytime.

Stuck? Reply to the workshop email with a screenshot of what the terminal says. Please do not leave it until the morning.